

Benefits of Millets For Weight Management

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Millets are ancient cereals that are taking up more limelight as we grow conscious of our food and health. Popular once again as nutrient-rich grains, millets are bursting with essential vitamins, minerals and dietary fibres that make them so wonderful to consume. Often linked with aiding digestion, supporting diabetes and helping sustainable farming and food security, these rain-fed crops are also important for weight loss.

For those who are looking to shed a few kilos or maintain a healthy weight, you could explore adding millets to your diet. In this article, we'll delve deep into **millets for weight loss**, their nutritional profile and how to include them in your diet. So let's begin!

Millets and Their Nutritional Value H2

Millets are cereals grown in low-rainfall areas. They are ancient crops consumed for centuries in Asia and beyond. You should know about the 8 main millets: Bajra, Sorghum, Ragi, Little Millet, Kodo Millet, Foxtail Millet, Barnyard Millet, and Proso Millet. Millets are comparable to some of the most popular grains as they contain protein, micronutrients, phytochemicals and fibre, all while being gluten-free.

Here's a table to help you understand the nutritional profile of all millets.

Millet	Protein (g)	Dietary Fibre (g)	Minerals
Bajra	10.96	11.49	Calcium, Iron, Aluminium
Sorghum	9.97	10.22	Calcium, Iron, Aluminium, Arsenic
Ragi	7.16	11.18	Calcium, Iron, Aluminium, Copper

Little Millet	8.92	6.39	Calcium. Iron, Chromium, Copper
Kodo Millet	8.92	6.39	Calcium, Iron, Copper, Chromium
Foxtail Millet	12.30	-	Chromium and Copper
Barnyard Millet	6.20	-	Chromium and Copper
Proso Millet	12.50	-	Chromium and Copper

Millet and Weight Loss H2

Here are a few ways in which millets can provide weight management benefits:

- **Fibre content:** Most millets contain a moderate to high amount of dietary fibre. This fibre content can not only aid in digestion and proper bowel movement, but it can also increase satiety. This can lead to a prolonged feeling of fullness and reduced overeating or snacking between meals.
- **Micronutrients:** Furthermore, many foods we eat today can contain fewer micronutrients. Swapping our regular grains with millets can increase our micronutrient intake in the body which can boost glucose metabolism.
- **Lower glycemic index:** Millets have a lower glycemic index than other grains which means that having them will reduce sudden spikes in blood sugar. They promote a steady sugar level in the body, which can regulate the body's fat percentage by reducing adipose tissue.
- **Supports heart health:** Science has found that regularly consuming millets can decrease cardiovascular risk. How so? Millets may reduce triglycerides and LDL or bad cholesterol in the body and increase good cholesterol levels. Regular consumption can regulate blood pressure levels and also decrease BMI (Body Mass Index) by nearly 7%.

However, it must be noted that simply having more millets does not result in weight loss. Good nutrition, sufficient sleep and regular exercise are all cornerstones of a healthy body and weight. You must prioritise all of these factors if your goal is weight loss or maintenance!

Different Millets and their Benefits H2

All in all, millets can help our health in various ways. Science has found that millets can provide a wide array of health benefits including diabetes management, lowering the risk of certain cancers, detoxifying the body, increasing immunity, and energy levels, and boosting muscular, neural and respiratory health. Millets may also provide protective benefits against some degenerative conditions. These benefits are mainly due to the number of essential nutrients and compounds

present in millets such as phenolic acids, resistant starch, lipids, antioxidants, flavonoids, lignans, lipids, antioxidants, etc.

Here is an overview of the millets and the unique health benefits they provide:

1. **Sorghum:** Has antioxidants that can reduce inflammation, and also shows anti-cancer properties
2. **Bajra:** Can boost teeth and bone health, helps manage diabetes and has antioxidants that can help support heart health
3. **Ragi or finger millet:** Inhibits cataract eye lens, lowers plasma glucose levels, has antimicrobial effects
4. **Foxtail Millet:** Anti-hyperglycemic effects
5. **Proso Millet:** Improves HDL, lowers triglycerides, prevents cardiovascular conditions
6. **Kodo Millet:** Anti-ageing effects
7. **Barnyard Millet:** Improves HDL levels
8. **Little Millet:** Boosts immunity

How to Include Millets in Your Diet H2

There are many ways to add more millets to your diet.

- For breakfast, you can choose to make Ragi dosas for a delicious and fibre-rich meal. You can use millets to make staples like upma, porridge etc.
- You can use millet flour to mix with your regular atta for nutritious rotis that can help manage weight.
- For snacks too, choose to make cookies, pops, cakes, barfis, laddoos and more using millet flours in the mix for a touch of health.
- In short, try to swap your regular grains with millets wherever possible to get the best of them.
- Make sure you consult with your physician before consuming them. Refrain from having high-fibre millets like Ragi at night as they can make you feel too full, resulting in sleep disruptions and so on. That's why it's best to confirm with your doctor about the quantity and type of millets you should be having before starting.

Conclusion H2

Millets are a powerhouse of nutrition and dietary fibre, all of which play important roles in providing several health benefits including aiding weight management. They have a lower GI, a high mix of micronutrients and boost heart health too. Millets make for an excellent alternative to the popular and commonly used grains we have in our kitchens today. We can replace them with millets or add them to our regular flours to add more nourishing ingredients to our diet. There are tons of recipes for you to try to aid weight management using millets such as ragi dosa, ragi malt, millet upma, millet lemon rice etc. Try these out and start on your weight loss journey today!

For more such informative articles on nutrition, health and ageing, keep reading Right Shift. We have a variety of articles on such topics and can surely help expand your knowledge and give you a much-needed dose of motivation to prioritise your health. We also have a free health score calculator to give you more insights into your current health status and our free meal plan creator to make positive changes in your diet to match your health goals. If you're interested, try it now! We have a plan for weight loss too!

FAQs

1. Are millets gluten-free?

Yes, most millets are gluten-free which makes them perfect for consumption for those with gluten allergies.

2. How much millet should I consume daily for weight loss?

You must check with your doctor about the healthy amount of millets you can consume. They can guide you based on your health, age, and medical conditions. Having an excess amount without consulting your doctor may not be as beneficial for weight loss and other health objectives.